



EXECUTIVE TALK

GitHub Cloud: A Platform Decision, Not a Hosting Decision

Building the business case to move from GitHub Enterprise Server

30–40 Minutes

Engineering Leaders

Security & Platform

The Decision Standard

Move only if a representative pilot shows that the benefits outweigh **migration risk and transition cost.**

Reduce risk

Faster remediation, stronger control coverage, and less internally owned reliability risk.

Improve delivery

Shorter cycle time, better developer experience, and governed access to new capabilities.

Simplify operations

Less platform toil with clear ownership for the operations that remain.

Evidence required: baseline, pilot result, transition estimate

No proven net benefit → do not proceed



Why Now? The Operating Model Has Changed



Identity & Policy



Pull Requests



Security



Automation



AI & Agents

GitHub is becoming the engineering control plane.

The opportunity cost of Server now includes delayed or unavailable cloud-native workflows—not only appliance operations.

The Business Problem We Are Solving

Platform work competes with product work

Upgrades, capacity, resilience, and appliance incidents consume engineering capacity.

Controls scale slowly

Rollout depends on release currency, runner capacity, and local integrations.

Capability access is delayed

Cloud-first AI, governance, and remediation widen the availability gap.

Governance is fragmented

Permissions, policies, repository settings, and audit patterns drift.

Reliability risk is internally owned

Availability, failover, backup integrity, restore, and recovery remain internal.

Workflows stop at the platform boundary

Agents, AI review, and remediation cannot operate as one governed loop.



Do Not Lead with COGS



Cost-only migration

- Savings consumed by migration and coexistence
- Disruption without visible developer benefit
- New consumption charges surprise sponsors
- Weak reason to change established workflows



Outcome-led migration

- Reduced security exposure and remediation time
- Lower internally owned reliability risk
- Faster engineering flow and governed AI adoption
- Platform capacity redirected to differentiated work

COGS is one row in the scorecard—not the headline.



Five Outcomes That Justify the Move



Security

Prevention, coverage,
remediation



Reliability

Availability, recovery,
capacity



Effectiveness

Flow, quality,
onboarding



Simplicity

Less maintenance and
toil



Capability

Cloud-native AI and
agents

MTTR

Secrets blocked

Incidents

Recovery evidence

PR cycle time

Change failure rate

Ops hours

Policy lead time

Release-to-adoption

Agent-ready repos



Cloud vs. Server: Executive Scorecard

DIMENSION	ENTERPRISE CLOUD	ENTERPRISE SERVER
Operations	GitHub-operated service	Customer-operated appliance and resilience
Feature velocity	Continuous, generally cloud-first	Release and upgrade dependent
Control	SaaS service boundaries	Infrastructure, network, and timing control
Security	Broadest current integrated portfolio	Strong core controls; customer owns currency and capacity
AI & agents	Hosted Copilot, code review, cloud agent	Distinct GHES 3.22 offline CLI technical preview
Economics	Seats plus consumption	Seats plus infrastructure and operations



Where Server Can Still Be the Right Choice

Disconnected operation

Air-gapped or tightly isolated environments without dependable GitHub service connectivity.

Infrastructure sovereignty

Direct control of placement, network boundaries, maintenance, backup, and forensic access.

Unmet residency requirements

Required geography or data-flow boundary is not supported by documented GHE.com options.

Critical legacy coupling

Integration incompatibility or remediation risk outweighs near-term Cloud value.

A requirement-led decision is stronger than a blanket claim that either platform is “more secure.”



Security Posture: Change the Work

Cloud shared responsibility

- ✓ GitHub operates the platform
- Customer governs identity and permissions
- Customer configures policies and integrations
- Customer triages and remediates findings
- Customer governs runners and workflows

Server adds platform responsibility

- + Patching and feature upgrades
- + Capacity and network configuration
- + Backup, HA, failover, and recovery
- + Monitoring and appliance incidents
- + Security tooling and content currency

The value is redirecting effort from maintaining controls to increasing coverage and reducing exposure.



Advanced Security: Cloud-Native Advantage

CAPABILITY	CLOUD	SERVER*
Secret scanning & push protection	Available	Available
Code scanning / CodeQL / default setup	Available	Available
PR status checks and merge gates	Available	Available
Security campaigns	Stronger documented portfolio	Validate release
Classic Copilot Autofix	Available	No parity claim
Agentic Autofix	Cloud-only preview	Not documented

*GHES availability depends on installed release, licensing, runner capacity, and configuration.



AI & Agents Change the Platform Equation

GitHub Enterprise Cloud

- ✓ Copilot Business and Enterprise
- ✓ Central policy and consumption visibility
- ✓ Copilot code review
- ✓ Asynchronous cloud coding agent
- ✓ Agent-assisted security remediation

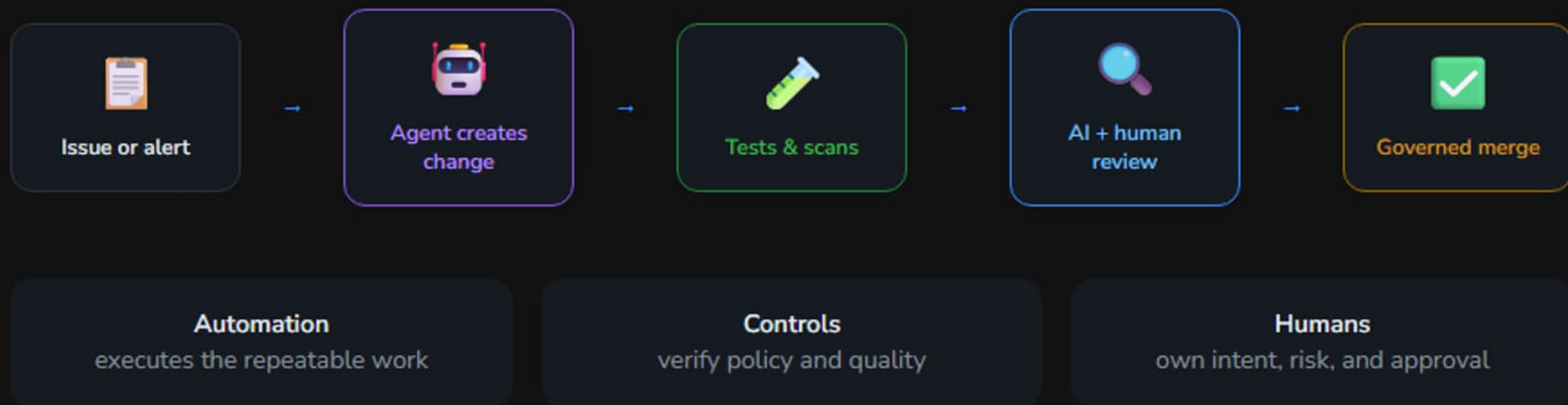
GitHub Enterprise Server

- Standard hosted Copilot plans not documented for GHES
- GHES 3.22: separate offline CLI technical preview
- Customer-configured model endpoint
- Not the cloud coding agent or code review
- Customer owns model capacity and governance

This is a delivery-system difference—not an autocomplete difference.



The Cloud-Native Engineering Loop





Reliability and Operational Simplicity

Internally owned on Server

Capacity and performance

Upgrade projects and maintenance windows

Replica health, failover, and traffic redirection

Backup integrity, restore, and recovery tests

Still owned in Cloud

Identity, policy, and audit operations

Runner, workflow, and integration resilience

Incident communication and continuity plans

Consumption governance and platform ownership

Measure reduced effort and risk. Do not assume "SaaS" means "no operations."



Consumption and Cost: Build the Full Model

Current Server

- Licenses
- Compute, storage, network
- Backup, HA, DR
- Runners and artifacts
- Platform labor
- Upgrade and incident effort

Future Cloud

- Enterprise seats
- Security active committers
- Copilot seats and AI credits
- Actions and runners
- Storage and data transfer
- Governance and FinOps

Transition

- Discovery and remediation
- Migration tooling
- Parallel operation
- Integration changes
- Training and support
- Contingency and rework

Compare total consumption and operations—not an appliance invoice with a Cloud seat price.



Value Model: Measure What Changes

MEASURE	EVIDENCE SOURCE	TARGET BASIS	OWNER
Critical alert remediation time	Security telemetry	Approved exposure reduction	Security
Developer-impacting incidents	Incident records	Lower frequency and severity	Platform
Pull-request cycle time	GitHub insights / DORA	Pilot improvement vs. baseline	Engineering
Platform operations hours	Time and cost records	Validated capacity redirected	Platform
Release-to-governed-adoption	Release and policy log	Within approved adoption window	Product

Conservative

slow adoption, long coexistence

Expected

pilot-proven, planned waves

Upside

broad adoption, rapid retirement



Minimize Disruption with Migration Waves



Discover

Inventory, classify,
baseline



Design

Identity, network,
governance



Pilot

Representative—not
easiest



Waves

Dependencies,
cutover, validate



Stabilize

Adopt, measure,
decommission

Migration reality: GEI is not a complete environment clone and does not provide delta migration.

Risk control: trial migrations, validation, source-change control, coexistence, and explicit contingency.



Decision Gates and Risk Controls

Identity & governance

Provisioning, roles, policies, audit, external collaboration

Residency & compliance

Region, data flows, telemetry, support, Copilot boundaries

Network & integrations

Runners, apps, APIs, packages, webhooks, connectivity

Repository fidelity

History, metadata, rules, LFS, unsupported data

Change readiness

Training, support, champions, communications, adoption

Operating model

Platform product, security operations, ownership, FinOps

Pause when a critical dependency has no safe migration path—or when the case still depends mainly on optimistic savings.



Migrate for Measurable Capability Uplift

We are not moving repositories to save on servers. We are modernizing the engineering control plane to improve **security**, **reliability**, **developer flow**, and **governed AI adoption**—provided a representative pilot proves those outcomes with acceptable risk.

Baseline outcomes

Validate exact gaps

Pilot representative work

Decide with evidence



Decision Sources

Enterprise Cloud overview

Service model and enterprise administration ↗

Enterprise Server overview

Deployment and customer responsibilities ↗

GitHub Enterprise Importer

Supported migration scope and sources ↗

Enterprise Live Migrations

Reduced-disruption repository migration ↗

Copilot plans

Availability, policy, and plan differences ↗

Copilot cloud agent

Asynchronous agent workflow ↗

GitHub Advanced Security

Code Security and Secret Protection ↗

Product billing

Seats, usage, and consumption categories ↗

Capability claims are version-, plan-, region-, policy-, and preview-dependent. Validate against the installed GHES release and target Cloud configuration.